

By **Gaurav Agarwal**

A TOUGH RULEBOOK FOR **AI AGENTS**

AS AI SYSTEMS MAKE REAL-TIME DECISIONS ACROSS FUNCTIONS, **FIRMS NEED ORCHESTRATION-LED GOVERNANCE,** A BUILT-IN CONTROL LAYER THAT IMPARTS ACCOUNTABILITY, POLICY ALIGNMENT AND ABILITY TO INTERVENE AS AGENTS OPERATE



India Inc. is entering a new phase of artificial intelligence, one defined less by tools and more by systems that can act. What began as isolated AI pilots is moving towards interconnected networks of models, assistants and, increasingly, autonomous agents. These agents are not just supporting decisions; they are starting to make them, often in real time and across functions. From customer engagement and credit risk to supply chains and IT operations, AI is now being embedded in core workflows. As enterprises scale these capabilities, a more fundamental question emerges: how do you stay in control of systems designed to operate independently?

Traditional governance frameworks were not built for this. Policies, audits and periodic reviews work in stable environments. They struggle when AI systems are continuously learning, interacting and making decisions at machine speed. This is where orchestration-led AI governance comes into focus. A recent report by the IBM Institute of Business Value found that organisations using holistic orchestration had over six times the productivity impact of those focused only on compliance. Yet

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